

1 / 5 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

Two clues, one animal

What we are practising

Eliminate choices that fail either clue.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Name the four choices aloud.

Before you begin

Draw or write cat, duck, fish and butterfly.

An adult reads or explains as needed and uses intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Read: "I have wings. I also have feathers."
2. Find choices with wings, then check the second clue.
3. Explain why duck fits and butterfly does not; invent another clue pair.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Which clue distinguishes the two winged animals?

Space to explore

2 / 5 | Ages 5-6 | 15 minutes

Guide the robot on a grid

What we are practising

Plan and test a sequence of directional steps.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

An adult draws arrows while the child points.

Before you begin

Draw a 3-by-3 grid; start bottom-left and put a star top-right.

An adult reads or explains as needed and uses intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Use a finger as the robot; one arrow moves one square.
2. Plan four moves to the star without leaving the grid.
3. Follow the arrows exactly and change any mistaken instruction.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Can another four-move route reach the star?

Space to explore

3 / 5 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

Find the broken pattern

What we are practising

Identify a repeating unit and check a sequence against it.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Use claps and taps instead of marks.

Before you begin

Draw circle, square, triangle, circle, square, circle.

An adult reads or explains as needed and uses intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Explain that the first three shapes are the unit to repeat.
2. Read the sequence and stop where it breaks the rule.
3. Replace the sixth shape, then add the next three.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Which three shapes repeat as one group?

Space to explore

4 / 5 | Ages 5-6 | 15 minutes

Build from a spoken plan

What we are practising

Give precise instructions and compare models.

What you need

Six large blocks in two matching sets of three

Draw two matching sets of shapes instead.

Before you begin

Have the other builder face away while you arrange your set.

Use lightweight blocks on the floor and keep the model low.

Try it together

1. Place two blocks side by side with the third centred on top.
2. Describe the model without showing it and let the listener build.
3. Reveal both models, compare and improve one unclear instruction.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Which words explain where the third block belongs?

Space to explore

5 / 5 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

Guess my sorting rule

What we are practising

Use examples and counterexamples to test a rule.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Use large objects with wheels and without wheels.

Before you begin

Draw car and bicycle in a yes group; tree and cup in a no group.

An adult reads or explains as needed and uses intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Explain that one secret feature decides each group.
2. Invite “has wheels” as a possible rule and test a bus drawing.
3. Test a ball, which rolls but has no wheels, and discuss the rule.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Does everything that rolls have wheels?

Space to explore

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

1. Two clues, one animal

A little hint

Does a butterfly have feathers?

Answer / what to notice

Only the duck among these choices has both wings and feathers.

An answer must fit every clue, not just the first.

Make it easier

Offer only duck and fish.

Take it further

Dictate two clues with exactly one answer among the four.

Another day, away from the screen

Try two-clue guessing with household objects.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

2. Guide the robot on a grid

A little hint

You need two moves up and two right.

Answer / what to notice

Up, up, right, right works; other orders of two ups and two rights also work.

Testing instructions one at a time reveals where a sequence needs repair.

Make it easier

Use one row of three squares.

Take it further

Block the middle square and find two routes avoiding it.

Another day, away from the screen

Draw new start and finish positions and exchange instructions.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

3. Find the broken pattern

A little hint

Compare positions one and four, then two and five.

Answer / what to notice

The sixth should be a triangle; next come circle, square, triangle.

Once a repeating unit is agreed, its positions become predictable.

Make it easier

Use an alternating circle-square pattern.

Take it further

Make a four-part repeating unit with one error for an adult.

Another day, away from the screen

Design a border with the repaired pattern.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

4. Build from a spoken plan

A little hint

Use beside, on top and in the middle instead of “there”.

Answer / what to notice

Two blocks form the base and one sits centrally above them; discuss differences without blame.

Comparing models shows which instructions need more detail.

Make it easier

Keep the model visible during building.

Take it further

Use four blocks per set and invite a clarifying question.

Another day, away from the screen

Describe a drawing for someone else to reproduce.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

5. Guess my sorting rule

A little hint

Check the no examples as well as the yes examples.

Answer / what to notice

The intended rule is “has wheels”: bus is yes and ball is no.

New examples distinguish similar rules, such as rolling and having wheels.

Make it easier

State the rule and sort together.

Take it further

Invent a rule with two yes and two no examples.

Another day, away from the screen

Play another round with things worn on feet.